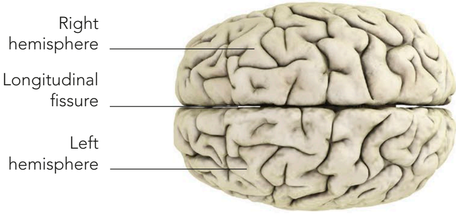
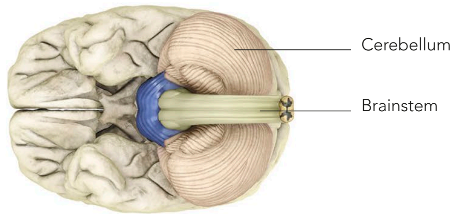
OUTER BRAIN STRUCTURES

The cerebrum is partly separated into two halves (cerebral hemispheres) by the deep longitudinal fissure. The cerebellum is the smaller bulbous structure beneath, responsible for muscle control. Below the cerebellum is the brainstem, which controls basic life processes.



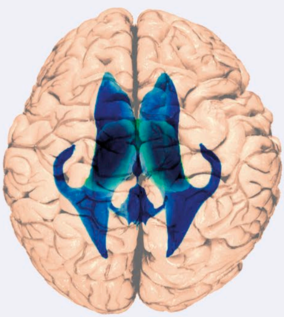
TOP VIEW



BOTTOM VIEW

THE HOLLOW BRAIN

The brain is, in a sense, hollow: it contains four chambers known as ventricles, which are filled with cerebrospinal fluid, or CSF (see p.89). There are two lateral ventricles, one in each hemisphere, and the CSF fluid is produced here. It then drains via the interventricular foramen into the third ventricle, which is situated close to the thalamus and occupies a more central position. From here it flows through the cerebral aqueduct and into the fourth ventricle, which extends down between the pons and cerebellum into the medulla. The total volume of CSF in the ventricles is about 25ml (9/10 fl oz). Circulation is aided by head movements and pulsations of the cerebral arteries.



VIEW FROM ABOVE
The lateral ventricles have frontward-, backward-, and side-facing horns, or cornua. The central third ventricle lies between them in this view.